

Pranav Pativada

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EDUCATION

Australian National University (ANU)

Feb. 2021 – Jun. 2025

ANU, Canberra

- Bachelor of Philosophy (PhB) (Science) – Honours. Majoring in **Computer Science** and **Machine Learning**.
- **6.72/7 GPA. 86% Weighted Average Mark (High Distinction Average).**
- Honours in **numerical optimisation** with **Oxford Visual Geometry Group**.
- Courses in **compilers, operating systems, algorithms, networks** and **formal verification**.

PUBLICATIONS/AWARDS

- **Best Project @ Alignment Research Bootcamp Oxford 2025:** Refusal and Incapability as directions in open-source models
- **Best Paper Runner Up @ DICTA 2023:** Contrastive-Aware ViT for Weakly Supervised Semantic Segmentation.
- **Runner Up @ 2024 BlueDot Impact AI Alignment Projects:** Exploring The Intersection of Interpretability and Optimisation.
- **Acknowledgement in RSS 2025 Submission:** Interior Point Differential Dynamic Programming.

EXPERIENCE

SWE Contractor

Feb. 2025

METR, Remote

- Baselining **SWE** and **MLE** tasks for **model evaluations**.

Alignment Research Participant

Jan. 2025

OAIS, University of Oxford

- Researched **mechanistic interpretability** and **reinforcement learning** under the Oxford AI Safety Initiative.
- **Steered** open-source models to intervene with incapability, an extension to the **refusal steering work**. This won best project.

Software Engineer Intern

Nov. 2023 – Feb. 2024

IMC Trading, Sydney

- Implemented a **scalable** and **efficient data streaming system** for services to access recent historic trading parameters using **Kafka**.
- Implemented a **shareable LRU cache** with **configurable eviction** and **down sampling** for each IMC client.

Machine Learning Research Intern

Nov. 2022 – Nov. 2023

CSIRO Data61, Canberra

- Implemented a novel **contrastive learning** algorithm to improve initial **class-activation maps** for baseline **Vision Transformer** models.
- This resulted in a publication and a runner up award at DICTA 2023.

Software Engineer

Feb. 2023 – Nov. 2023

Geospatial Intelligence Pty Ltd, Canberra

- Created a **full-stack application** for farmers track crop output and carbon footprints. Implemented **REST API's** and **CRUD** operations.

SKILLS

- **Languages** Python (PyTorch, Numpy), Java (Kafka, Guava, Dagger), C, JavaScript
- **Tools** Git, Bash, Docker, LaTeX